

Scopus Publications

Publishing in Elsevier's leading abstract and citation database

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Scopus Publications refers to research articles indexed in Scopus, one of the largest abstract and citation databases of peer-reviewed literature, widely used for research evaluation and university rankings.

DEFINITION

Research articles published in journals, conference proceedings, or books indexed in the Scopus database, maintained by Elsevier.

WHY IT MATTERS

Scopus indexing is a major criterion for university rankings, faculty evaluation, and research funding decisions worldwide, making it one of the most influential publication metrics globally.

WORKING PRINCIPLE

INPUT / PROBLEM

CORE PROCESS

OUTCOME / APPLICATION

Scopus evaluates journals and conference proceedings against quality criteria before indexing them, then tracks citations across indexed content to generate metrics like CiteScore and author h-index.

QUICK FACTS

- Scopus indexes tens of thousands of journals from thousands of publishers worldwide
- Scopus assigns each researcher a unique Author ID to track their publication history
- Scopus and Web of Science are the two most widely used citation databases globally

KEY TERMS

CiteScore

Author ID

Quartile ranking

Citation database

h-index

CORE CONCEPTS

- CiteScore metric
- Author and institution profiles
- Journal quartile ranking
- Citation network analysis

APPLICATIONS

- University ranking calculations
- Faculty research performance evaluation
- Grant and funding applications
- Research collaboration network analysis

REAL-LIFE EXAMPLES

- A university's QS ranking partly based on Scopus-indexed output
- A researcher's Scopus Author ID tracking their citation history
- Conference proceedings seeking Scopus indexing for visibility

ADVANTAGES

- One of the largest multidisciplinary citation databases
- Widely used in global university rankings
- Covers both journals and conference proceedings

LIMITATIONS

- Indexing criteria can exclude some regional or niche journals
- Coverage varies significantly by discipline
- Requires ongoing journal compliance to remain indexed

CAREER OPPORTUNITIES

Research analyst, Bibliometrics specialist, Academic publishing consultant, University research office administrator

INDUSTRY APPLICATIONS

Higher education rankings, Research funding agencies, Academic publishing, Corporate R&D benchmarking

RESEARCH AREAS

Bibliometric analysis, Research evaluation methodology, Journal quality metrics, Citation network mapping

FUTURE SCOPE

Continued growth in AI-assisted citation analysis is expected to make Scopus-based research evaluation more nuanced and discipline-aware.

CURRENT TRENDS

Growing use of Scopus data combined with AI tools to assess research impact beyond simple citation counts.

SUMMARY

Scopus publications are indexed in one of the world's largest citation databases, heavily influencing university rankings, funding decisions, and researcher evaluation globally.